

A note on how this book was made

This book was written with Claude. The ideas, the stories, the framing: those are mine. But I'm not a natural writer. I struggle to structure an argument, and I miss my own contradictions. AI closed that gap. It helped me find holes I couldn't see because I was too close to the material. It made writing this possible at all.

This book argues that AI can quietly erode the friction that produces shared understanding when we let it replace the conversations that build it. I'm aware of the irony in using AI to write that argument.

Claude helped me think more clearly about arguments I already held. The moments that changed the book came when other people challenged those arguments from outside my own framing. I tried to build that friction back in the only way I had: publishing the argument as a blog series before finishing the book, and letting readers push back in public. Matthias asking "why do I need the team" did more for this book than any private editing pass could have. That pushback was the same mechanism this book argues for, just run in public instead of in a room.

Matthias Meisinger, Johann Blauensteiner, Bernhard Dieber, Carla Koeberl, and Giulia di Pietro read the first version of this book. It was the rough one, before any of this held together, and they told me what wasn't working. Thank you for getting through it.

I still don't know if that was enough. Judge for yourself. That's what the rest of this book is for.